

Instructor Notes

Lab 1 - Basic Connectivity

Students verify correct network configuration and students practice using ping and interpreting connectivity results.

Lab 2 - Firewall Control

Students apply and test nftables rules and students validate correct blocking behavior and understand packet filtering.

Lab 3 - Incident Response

Students create a structured incident report and students demonstrate evidence collection and documentation skills.

Common Pitfalls

Forgetting to run commands with sudo, resulting in permission errors, using incorrect or mismatched IP addresses between VMs, testing firewall rules in the wrong direction (client → server instead of server → client), and forgetting to restart services after modifying configurations.

Safety Note

All scripts and packet-generation tools in these labs create synthetic, isolated training traffic only. No real-world or harmful traffic is produced, and all activity remains contained within the virtual range environment.

1. What was the hardest part of the exercise?

Which tasks required the most troubleshooting. What commands or configurations they struggled with.

2. How did the dashboard help you see network status?

How the readiness bar indicated progress. How node color-coding helped identify issues quickly.